MIL-B-23276C(ME)
15 July 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-23276B(ME)
20 May 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BALLS, WRECKING

This specification is approved for use by the Mobility Equipment Research and Development Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two sizes of wrecking balls.

1.2 Classification. Wrecking balls shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 1,500 pounds.
Size 2 - 6,000 pounds.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

STANDARDS
FEDERAL

FED. STD. No. 356	- Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of US Military Property.

FSC 3815

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-19T16:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Copies of standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

NATIONAL BUREAU OF STANDARDS (NBS)

Handbook H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

A 27 - Mild to Medium-Strength Carbon-Steel Castings for General Application.
A 48 - Gray Iron Castings.
A 307 - Carbon Steel Externally and Internally Threaded Standard Fasteners.
A 490 - Quenched and Tempered Alloy Steel Bolts for Structural Steel Joints.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, ATTN: Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight CLassification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., ATTN: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-19T16:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The Size 1 wrecking ball shall be spherical shaped and made of gray cast iron conforming to ASTM A 48, Class 40C. The Size 2 wrecking ball shall be made of cast steel conforming to ASTM A 27, Grade 70-36, and shall be spherical or pear shaped, as specified (see 6.2). Wrecking balls shall be cast with a smooth surface and have a weight tolerance of plus 10 percent or minus 5 percent.

3.2 Lifting connection.

3.2.1 Size 1 wrecking ball. The Size 1 wrecking ball shall be supplied with a lifting eye fabricated from 1-5/8-inch round steel bar conforming to ASTM A 307, and forming a ring with a 3-inch inside diameter having not less than a 3-inch threaded stem with 8 threads per inch in accordance with Handbook H28, and inserted into a matched, drilled, and threaded hole in the wrecking ball. The stem shall be staked to prevent turning.

3.2.2 Size 2 wrecking ball. The Size 2 wrecking ball shall be cast to provide part of a clevis-type lifting connection. A depression in the form of a semicircular slot, not less than 14 inches in diameter and not less than 2 inches wide, shall be cored in the casting to permit a link or loop to drop not less than 7 inches into the cavity. A hole, at right angles to the long axis of the depression, 2-1/16 inches (plus 1/16 inch, minus 0 inch) in diameter and located with its center 4 inches (plus or minus 1/16 inch) from the top shall be made for insertion of a bolt to secure the lifting line or chain. A 2-inch diameter, high tensile steel bolt conforming to ASTM A 490, of suitable length (plus extra for bolting) with machine threaded ends and matching machine nuts with plain hardened washers shall be provided for insertion into the wrecking ball as a lifting connection.

3.3 Identification marking. Wrecking balls shall be marked for identification in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.3.1 Stenciling. The weight of the wrecking balls shall be stenciled near the lifting connection.

3.4 Workmanship.

3.4.1 Machine work. Tolerances and gages for metal fits shall conform to the limitations specified herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-19T16:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.2 Castings. Steel castings shall be sound and free from defects in accordance with ASTM A 27, Grade 70-36 and cast iron castings shall be sound and free from defects in accordance with ASTM A 48, Class 40C.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) Quality conformance examination (see 4.3).
(b) Inspection of packaging (see 4.5).

4.3 Quality conformance examination.

4.3.1 Examination. The wrecking ball shall be examined as specified in 4.4. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Examination. The wrecking ball shall be examined for the following defects:

101. Identification marking not as specified.
102. Lifting connections not as specified.
103. Stenciling not as specified.
104. Workmanship not as specified.
105. Material not as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-19T16:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5 Inspection of packaging. The marking of the balls shall be examined to determine compliance with the referenced document. Any marking that is missing, illegible, incorrect, or incomplete shall be cause for rejection.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packing (see 6.3). The balls shall be prepared for shipment in a manner to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at lowest ratings in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.2 Marking. (See 6.2.)

5.2.1 Military. Marking for military shipment and storage shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.2.2 Commercial. Marking for commercial packaging shall be in accordance with FED. STD. No. 356.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The wrecking balls are intended for use in demolition operations.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of wrecking ball required (see 1.2).
(c) Shape of Size 2 wrecking ball required (see 3.1).
(d) Type of marking required (see 5.2).

6.3 The nature of the item is such, that any other degree of preservation and packing would be impractical.

Custodian:
Army - ME

Review activities:
Army - AT
DSA - CS

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

Project 3815-A092

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-19T16:17Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.